

A *text editor* is a program designed for writing and editing code.

Most text editors have features to make writing and editing code easier: *syntax highlighting*, for example, colors your code so you can quickly recognize different parts of a program—a string might be green and a method might be purple.

Sublime Text, Atom, and Geany are some commonly used beginner-friendly text editors because of their ease of use and familiar interfaces. They also have powerful features that help you work more efficiently as you learn.

Emacs and Vim are advanced text editors that were introduced in the 1970s. Their learning curve is steep, but once you learn to use them well, writing and editing code is incredibly efficient. Most Linux systems install Vim, or its predecessor vi, by default.